Arguments in support of or in opposition to the proposed laws are the opinions of the authors.

Argument Against Measure ___

This measure would repeal a lawful rate increase that was based on an independent professional analysis of the five-year operational and capital investment needs of the water utility. The rate increase was implemented after public notice and opportunity for protest. Only 18 percent of customers submitted a protest, far less than the 50 percent required to stop the increase.

Safe and reliable water supply is often taken for granted. However, the delivery of water in Bear Valley Springs depends upon a very complex system that is over 50 years old and has received very little upgrade or replacement over those years.

Recent projects, including a booster station, a water main, and a water master plan, show CSD commitment to investment. However, if the approved rates are repealed, revenue would be reduced by approximately $10 million through 2031. This would make it more difficult or impossible to obtain project financing and cause deferment or cancellation of essential projects- projects needed to continue rebuilding aging water mains, wells, booster stations and tanks.

Water loss through leakage from aging mains will continue to increase. Reliability of water supply will continue to decline and heavy dependence on imported rather than local supply will continue. Imported supply incurs high purchase and pumping costs and its reliability is subject to many factors beyond local control.

With less revenue to support operations, service reductions such as longer response time for leak repair and elimination of a planned fire hydrant testing program may be necessary. As leakage continues and proactive upgrades are deferred, operational costs and the need for costly emergency repairs will rise. Water main leaks and breaks also damage roads and sometimes damage private property.

Absent sufficient revenue for operations, maintenance, and investment, a locally operated and controlled water utility will eventually become unsustainable.

Primary Argument Signers Form			Author	Verified
No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument. If more than five signatures are submitted, the first five listed shall be printed. Names and titles listed will be printed in the order that they are listed below. Place a checkmark in the author column if the signer is author of the argument. A signer can only list one title. Honorifics such as M.D., Dr., Esquire, etc. with a name are not accepted. If the signers are part of a bona fide association, there is no requirement that they be eligible to vote on the measure. However, for each such signing individual, the title under the signer's name must list the name of that bona fide association and may include their position within that association. By signing below, the undersigned state that they have read the argument and believe it not to be false or misleading. **Type** information clearly.			Check if the signer is the author of the argument. Authors must be signers.	(FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY) Staff Initial once the eligibility of the signer is verified.
1.	Name:PAUL PAPARELLA	Title: BOARD PRESIDENT	X	☐
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